

University of Minnesota - Twin Cities

Department of Economics
4-101 Hanson Hall
1925 Fourth Street South
Minneapolis, MN 55455
U.S.A.

Placement Directors

Kyle Herkenhoff
(612) 624-4558
kfh@umn.edu

Aldo Rustichini
(612) 625-4816
rusti001@umn.edu

Placement Coordinator

Wesley Peterson
(612) 625-6859
pete6046@umn.edu

**Curriculum Vitae
Fall 2026**

Johanna Torres Chain

Personal Data*Address*

4-101 Hanson Hall
1925 Fourth Street South
Minneapolis, MN 55455

Contact Information

Cell: (+1) 612-226-8939
Email: torre750@umn.edu; torreschainj@gmail.com
URL: <https://torreschainj.github.io>

Citizenship: Colombia, F-1 visa

Major Fields of Concentration

Macroeconomics; Household Finance; Labor Macroeconomics; Aging and Health

Education

Degree	Field	Institution	Year
PhD	Economics	University of Minnesota (expected)	2027
MA	Economics	University of Minnesota	2024
MA	Economics	Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Chile / Georgetown University	2017
BA	Economics	Universidad del Norte, Colombia	2015

Dissertation

Title: “Family Care as Informal Insurance: Medicaid, Marriage, and Widowhood in Old Age”

Dissertation Advisor(s): Professor Mariacristina De Nardi

Expected Completion: Summer 2027

References

Reference Name	Email / Contact Info	Address
Professor Mariacristina De Nardi	denar001@umn.edu (612) 624-1978	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Professor Joseph Mullins	mullinsj@umn.edu (612) 625-7858	Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, 4-101 Hanson Hall, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55455
Dr. Alessandra Fogli	afogli00@gmail.com (612) 204-5485	Research Department, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, 90 Hennepin Avenue, Minneapolis, Minnesota 55401

Honors and Awards

2025–2026	<i>Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship</i> , National Bureau of Economic Research, supported by the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation
2026	<i>Best Poster Award</i> , Embrace Day Graduate Posters Session, Canadian Economics Association Annual Meetings, Vancouver, Canada
2025	<i>Conference Travel Grant</i> , Council of Graduate Students, University of Minnesota
2024	<i>Funding Award</i> , Health and Retirement Study Summer Workshop, University of Michigan
2023	<i>Distinguished Teaching Assistant</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2022	<i>Summer Graduate Fellowship</i> , Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota
2017	<i>Magna Cum Laude M.A. Graduation</i> , Universidad Alberto Hurtado
2016–2017	<i>Full Scholarship for Graduate Studies in Economics</i> , Georgetown University/ILADES
2015	<i>Honorable Mention—Best University Student</i> , Premios Portafolio, Colombia
2015	<i>Silver Medal for Academic Excellence</i> , Universidad del Norte, Colombia
2015	<i>Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis</i> , Universidad del Norte, Colombia

Research Experience

2023–Present	<i>Research Assistant</i> for Mariacristina De Nardi, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2018	<i>Research Fellow</i> , Inter-American Development Bank, Washington, DC. Worked with Andrés Fernández (IMF), Laura Alfaro (IDB and Harvard Business School), and Miguel Acosta (Central Bank of Chile).

Professional Experience

2019–2021	<i>Economic Advisor</i> , Central Bank of Chile. Part-time advisor to Board Member Pablo García Silva.
2018–2021	<i>Junior Economist</i> , Macroeconomic Analysis Department, Central Bank of Chile. Modeling and forecasting for the Monetary Policy Report.

Teaching Experience

Summer 2023	<i>Instructor</i> (Writing Sections) for Economic Development (Undergraduate), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2022–2023	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> for Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate), Department of Economics, University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, Minnesota.
2020	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> for Macroeconomics II (Graduate), Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Santiago, Chile.
2017	<i>Teaching Assistant</i> for Econometrics II (Graduate), Universidad Alberto Hurtado, Santiago, Chile.

Working Papers

Torres Chain, Johanna. “Family Care as Informal Insurance: Medicaid, Marriage, and Widowhood in Old Age” (**Job Market Paper**)

Presented by me: Canadian Public Economics Group Annual Meeting (Montréal, 2026); Inter-American Development Bank Research Conference (Washington, DC, 2026); Canadian Economics Association Annual Meeting (Van-

couver, 2026); Women in Macroeconomics Conference (Chicago, 2026).

Torres Chain, Johanna. “Substitutes for Saving: Family Care, Long-Term-Care Risk, and Race in Late Life”

Bullano, Francisco; Torres Chain, Johanna. “The Incidence of Health Risk: Home Production, Self-Insurance, and Who Bears the Cost”

Borella, Margherita; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Torres Chain, Johanna; Yang, Fang. “Why do (most) households save and work?” (Revise and resubmit at the *American Economic Review*)

Presented by me: Canadian Economics Association Annual Meeting (Vancouver, 2026); European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (Nicosia, Cyprus, 2025); Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting (Cleveland, 2025).

Work in Progress

Conti, Gabriella; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Giustinelli, Pamela; Torres Chain, Johanna; Wang, Fan. “Estimating Subjective Health Production Functions”

Referee Experience

Review of Economic Dynamics

Computer Skills

MATLAB, Stata, Fortran, R, EViews, Dynare Toolkit, LaTeX, Qualtrics, LimeSurvey

Languages

Spanish (native), English (fluent)

Abstract(s)

Torres Chain, Johanna. “Family Care as Informal Insurance: Medicaid, Marriage, and Widowhood in Old Age” (Job Market Paper)

This paper studies how family care changes the value of Medicaid long-term care insurance. Using HRS data, I estimate a lifecycle model of singles, couples, and widowed survivors with health risk, family care, saving, and means-tested Medicaid. Family care is worth \$24,970 to the age-70 recipient household but saves Medicaid only \$809 per household. A 10 percent floor expansion is worth \$2,843 with family care and \$3,647 without it, implying a 22.1 percent offset. The population offset is mostly non-spousal, while both care margins matter within couples. Widowhood raises Medicaid exposure from 3.4 to 12.5 percent primarily through reduced resources.

Torres Chain, Johanna. “Substitutes for Saving: Family Care, Long-Term-Care Risk, and Race in Late Life”

Black retirees hold about one-fifth the wealth of White retirees at age 70, and the ratio barely moves until death. Using the Health and Retirement Study, I document that Black single retirees receive roughly twice the family-provided care and reach the end of life with a quarter of the out-of-pocket medical spending of White decedents. I then estimate a life-cycle model in which family care insures long-term-care risk: intensively caregiving families face far lower nursing-home risk and hold less precautionary wealth. Common preferences with race-specific circumstances reproduce both groups’ wealth paths, and conditions at retirement account for 86–95 percent of the racial wealth gap after 70. Long-term-care reforms that compensate family caregivers and reforms that publicly insure institutional risk carry opposite racial incidence.

Borella, Margherita; De Nardi, Mariacristina; Torres Chain, Johanna; Yang, Fang. “Why do (most) households save and work?” (Revise and resubmit at the *American Economic Review*)

We quantify why most households save and work, using a life-cycle model with wage risk, endogenous labor supply of both spouses, marital transitions, health, medical expenses, mortality, and bequest motives at the death of the first and last household member, estimated on PSID and HRS data. A model with more motives to save and endogenous labor supply implies smaller roles for precautionary saving against wage risk and for bequest motives than previously suggested. Modeling the entire life cycle implies a larger role for medical expenses, because households save and work for them long before they retire. Marriage and divorce risk has large and offsetting effects on the savings of couples and singles, and thus small effects on aggregate savings, but affects aggregate earnings as much as wage risk.